Test 20:

READING PASSAGE 1

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 1–13**, which are based on Reading Passage 1 below.*

Dolls through the ages

What is today a simple children's toy has a surprisingly rich history. Dolls have been a part of humankind for thousands of years. Often depicting religious figures, or used as playthings, early dolls were probably made from primitive materials such as clay, fur, or wood.

Dolls constructed of flat pieces of wood, painted with various designs, and with 'hair' made of clay, have often been found in Egyptian graves dating back to 2000 BC. Egyptian tombs of wealthy families have included pottery dolls. Dolls being placed in these graves leads some to believe that they were cherished possessions.

Girls from ancient Greece and Rome offered their wooden dolls to goddesses after they were too 'grown-up' to play with dolls. Most ancient dolls that were found in tombs were very simple creations, often made from such materials as clay, rags, wood, or bone. Some of the more unique dolls were made with ivory or wax. The main goal was to make the doll as lifelike as possible. That ideal led to the creation of dolls with movable limbs and removable garments, dating back to 600 BC.

Following the era of the ancient dolls, Europe became a major hub for doll production. These dolls were primarily made of wood. Fewer than 30 examples of primitive wooden stump dolls from England survive today. The Grodnertal area of Germany produced many peg wooden dolls, a type of doll that has very simple peg joints and resembles a clothespin (a device for hanging washing on a clothesline). An alternative to wood was developed in the 1800s.

'Composition' is a collective term for mixtures of pulped wood or paper that were used to make doll heads and bodies. These mixtures were moulded under pressure, creating a durable doll that could be mass-produced. Manufacturers closely guarded the recipes for their mixtures, sometimes using strange ingredients like ash or eggshells. Papier-mâché, a type of composition, was one of the most popular mixtures.

In addition to wooden dolls, wax dolls grew in popularity in the 17th and 18th centuries. Munich in Germany was a major manufacturing centre for wax dolls. Wax dollmakers would model a doll's head in wax or clay, and then cover it with plaster to create a mould. Then they would pour melted wax into the cast. The wax for the head would be very thin, no more than 3 mm. Some of the most distinctive wax dolls were created in England between 1850 and 1930. One of the first dolls that portrayed a baby was made in England from wax at the beginning of the 19th century.

Around the same time, porcelain became popular. It is made by firing special clays in a kiln at more than 2372 degrees Fahrenheit (1300°C), and only a few clays can withstand firing at such high temperatures. Porcelain is used generically to refer to both china and bisque dolls; china is glazed, whereas bisque is unglazed. Germany, France, and Denmark started creating china heads for dolls in the 1840s. These china heads were replaced in the 1860s by ones made of bisque. Bisque, which is porcelain fired twice with colour added to it after the first firing, looked more like skin than china did.

In France, the bébé was popular in the 1880s, and it has become a highly sought-after doll today. The bébé, first made in the 1850s, was different from its predecessors because it depicted a younger girl. Until then, most French dolls were representations of adults. Although the French dolls were unrivalled in their artistry, German bisque dolls became quite popular because they were not as expensive. Kammer & Reinhardt introduced a bisque character doll in the 1900s, starting a trend of creating realistic dolls.

For many centuries, rag dolls were made by mothers for their children. The term 'rag doll' refers generically to dolls made of any fabric. 'Cloth doll' refers to a subset of rag dolls made of linen or cotton. Commercially produced rag dolls were first introduced in the 1850s by English and American manufacturers. Although not as sophisticated as dolls made from other materials, rag dolls were well loved, often as a child's first toy.

Dollmaking did not become an industry in the United States until after the Civil War in the 1860s. Doll production was concentrated in the New England region of the United States, with dolls made from a variety of materials such as leather, rubber, papier-mâché, and cloth. Celluloid was developed in the state of New Jersey in the late 1860s and was used to manufacture dolls until the mid-1950s. German, French, American, and Japanese factories churned out cheaply produced celluloid dolls in mass quantities. However, celluloid fell out of favour because of its extreme flammability and propensity to fade in bright light.

After World War I, dollmakers experimented with plastics. Hard plastic dolls were manufactured in the 1940s. They resembled composition dolls, but they were much more durable. Other materials used in doll manufacturing included rubber, foam rubber, and vinyl in the 1950s and 1960s. Vinyl changed dollmaking, allowing dollmakers to root hair into the head, rather than using wigs or painting the hair. Although most dolls are now mass-manufactured using these modern materials, many modern dollmakers are still using the traditional materials of the past to make collectible dolls.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 1–6

Complete the notes below.

*Choose **ONE WORD ONLY** from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 1–6 on your answer sheet.

Dolls

Earliest known dolls

- represented religious figures
- used as toys
- **Egypt, 2000 BC**
  - bodies were made of wood
  - **1** _____ was used for the hair
- **Ancient Greece and Rome**
  - dolls were given to **2** _____ by older girls
- **600 BC**
  - realistic dolls had separate clothes and **3** _____ that could be put in different positions

17th and 18th centuries

- dolls made of **4** _____ became more common
- moulds made of **5** _____

1800s

- new manufacturing process developed
- new group of mixtures known as **6** _____
- recipes for these mixtures kept secret

Questions 7–13

Do the following statements agree with the information in Reading Passage 1?

In boxes 7–13 on your answer sheet, write:

TRUE — *if the statement agrees with the information*
FALSE — *if the statement contradicts the information*
NOT GIVEN — *if there is no information about this*

7. Bisque dolls appear less realistic than dolls made of china.

8. French dolls tended to cost more than German bisque dolls.

9. The first rag dolls were made in the 1850s.

10. Only dolls made of cotton or linen are classified as cloth dolls.

11. Dolls made of celluloid tended to lose their colour.

12. Composition dolls lasted longer than the plastic dolls that were made in the 1940s.

13. Doll collectors prefer a doll to be dressed in its original clothing.

ĐÁP ÁN:

1. clay (Búp bê Ai Cập cổ đại có "tóc" làm bằng đất sét - "hair made of clay").

2. goddesses (Các cô gái ở Hy Lạp và La Mã cổ đại đã dâng búp bê cho các nữ thần khi họ trưởng thành).

3. limbs (Búp bê thực tế vào năm 600 TCN có các chi có thể cử động được - "movable limbs").

4. wax (Búp bê sáp trở nên phổ biến hơn vào thế kỷ 17 và 18).

5. plaster (Những người thợ làm búp bê sáp dùng thạch cao để tạo khuôn).

6. composition (Thuật ngữ dùng cho hỗn hợp bột gỗ hoặc giấy được phát triển vào những năm 1800).

7. FALSE (Ngược lại, búp bê Bisque trông giống da người hơn so với búp bê bằng sứ - "bisque... looked more like skin than china did").

8. TRUE (Búp bê sứ Đức trở nên phổ biến vì chúng không đắt đỏ như búp bê Pháp vốn không có đối thủ về tính nghệ thuật).

9. FALSE (Trong nhiều thế kỷ, búp bê giẻ rách đã được các bà mẹ làm cho con cái; năm 1850 chỉ là mốc lần đầu chúng được sản xuất thương mại).

10. TRUE (Bài đọc nêu: "'Cloth doll' refers to a subset of rag dolls made of linen or cotton").

11. TRUE (Búp bê Celluloid có xu hướng bị phai màu dưới ánh sáng mạnh - "propensity to fade in bright light").

12. FALSE (Búp bê nhựa cứng sản xuất vào những năm 1940 bền hơn nhiều so với búp bê hỗn hợp - "much more durable").

13. NOT GIVEN (Bài đọc không đề cập đến việc những người sưu tầm có thích búp bê mặc quần áo nguyên bản của chúng hay không).

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 2

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 14–26**, which are based on Reading Passage 2 below.*

Questions 14–19

Reading Passage 2 has six paragraphs **A–F**.

Choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

*Write the correct number, **i–ix**, in boxes 14–19 on your answer sheet.*

List of Headings

i Experimenting with an old idea
ii Life cycle of Madagascar spiders
iii Advances in the textile industry
iv Resources needed to meet the project's demands
v The physical properties of spider silk
vi A scientific analysis of spider silk
vii A unique work of art
viii Importance of the silk-textile market
ix Difficulties of raising spiders in captivity

14 Paragraph A
15 Paragraph B
16 Paragraph C
17 Paragraph D
18 Paragraph E
19 Paragraph F

A unique golden textile

A two-man project to use spider silk is achieved after 4 years

A

A rare textile made from the silk of more than a million wild spiders has been on display at the American Museum of Natural History in New York City. To produce this golden cloth, 70 people spent four years collecting golden-orb spiders from telephone poles in Madagascar, while another dozen workers carefully extracted about 80 feet of silk filament from each of the arachnids. The resulting 11-foot-by-4-foot textile is the only large piece of cloth made from natural spider silk in the world today.

B

Spider silk is very elastic and strong compared with steel or Kevlar, said textile expert Simon Peers, who co-led the project. Kevlar is a lightweight synthetic fabric, chemically related to nylon, that is used in bullet-proof vests. Kevlar is resistant to wear, tear and heat and has virtually no melting point. But the tensile strength of spider silk is even greater than Kevlar's aramid filaments and higher than that of high-grade steel. Most importantly, spider silk is extremely lightweight: a strand long enough to circle the Earth would weigh less than 500 grams (18 oz). It is also especially ductile, able to stretch up to 140 percent of its length without breaking and to retain its strength below −40 °C, giving it toughness equal to that of leading commercial fibres.

C

Researchers have long been intrigued by the unique properties of spider silk. Unfortunately, spider silk is extremely hard to mass-produce. Unlike silkworms—easy to raise in captivity—spiders have a habit of biting off each other's heads when housed together. According to Peers, there is intensive research worldwide aimed at replicating spider-silk tensile properties for use in medicine and industry, but no-one has yet reproduced all the qualities of natural silk.

D

Peers conceived the idea of weaving spider silk after reading about French missionary Jacob Paul Camboué, who worked with spiders in Madagascar during the 1880s and 1890s. Camboué built a small hand-driven machine to extract silk from up to 24 spiders at once, without harming them: the spiders were briefly restrained, their silk collected, then released. Peers built a replica of this 24-spider "silking" machine, said co-leader Nicholas Godley. As a test the pair collected about 20 spiders. "When we stuck them in the machine and started turning it, lo and behold, this beautiful gold-coloured silk started coming out," Godley recalled.

E

To make a textile of any significant size, the scale had to increase dramatically. Fourteen thousand spiders yield about an ounce of silk, Godley said, and the finished textile weighs about 2.6 pounds. By the end, handlers had worked with more than one million female golden-orb spiders—abundant in Madagascar and famed for their golden thread. Because the spiders produce silk only in the rainy season, all were collected between October and June. An additional 12 workers used hand-powered machines to extract the silk and twist it into 96-filament yarn. After “silking”, the spiders were released; within a week they regenerate their silk, allowing the same individuals to be used again—“the gift that never stops giving,” said Godley.

F

Spending four years to produce a single piece of cloth is hardly practical for scientists or companies hoping to exploit spider silk in biomedicine or as a Kevlar alternative. Several groups have inserted spider genes into bacteria and even goats to make silk, but results have been only partly successful. One reason is that spider silk begins as a liquid protein produced in a special gland in the abdomen. Using the spinneret, the spider applies force that rearranges the protein’s molecular structure, transforming it into solid fibre. “When we talk about a spider spinning silk, we’re talking about how it applies forces to convert liquid to solid,” explained spider-silk expert Todd Blackledge of the University of Akron, who was not involved in the project. “Every year we get closer to mass production, but we’re not there yet.” For now, we must be content with one extraordinarily beautiful cloth—courtesy of more than a million spiders.

Questions 20–23

Look at the following statements (Questions 20–23) and the list of researchers below.

Match each statement with the correct researcher, ***A, B or C****.*

Write the correct letter, ***A, B or C****, in boxes 20–23 on your answer sheet.*

NB You may use any letter more than once.

20 It takes a tremendous number of spiders to make a small amount of silk.

21 Scientists want to use the qualities of spider silk for medical purposes.

22 Scientists are making some progress in their efforts to manufacture spider silk.

23 Spider silk compares favourably to materials known for their strength.

List of Researchers

A Simon Peers
B Nicholas Godley
C Todd Blackledge

Questions 24–26

Complete the summary below.

Choose ***ONE WORD ONLY*** *from the passage for each answer.*

Write your answers in boxes 24–26 on your answer sheet.

Producing spider silk in the lab

Both scientists and manufacturers are interested in producing silk for many different purposes. Some researchers have tried to grow silk by introducing genetic material into **24** _____ and some animals. But these experiments have been somewhat disappointing.

It is difficult to make spider silk in a lab setting because the silk comes from a liquid protein made in a **25** _____ inside the spider's body. When a spider spins silk, it applies **26** _____ that turns this liquid into solid silk. Scientists cannot replicate this yet.

ĐÁP ÁN:

14. Paragraph A: vii (A unique work of art - *Tác phẩm nghệ thuật độc nhất vô nhị từ tơ nhện tự nhiên*)

o Explanation: This paragraph describes the "rare textile" as "the only large piece of cloth made from natural spider silk existing in the world today," emphasizing its uniqueness as a created object (a work of art).

15. Paragraph B: v (The physical properties of spider silk - *Các đặc tính vật lý như độ bền, độ đàn hồi, trọng lượng nhẹ*)

o Explanation: This paragraph details the characteristics of spider silk: "elastic and strong," "greater than... high-grade steel," "extremely lightweight," "especially ductile," and its strength below -40c.

16. Paragraph C: ix (Difficulties of raising spiders in captivity - *Khó khăn khi nuôi nhốt nhện vì chúng hay cắn nhau*)

o Explanation: This paragraph explains why spider silk is hard to mass-produce, citing the main difficulty: "spiders have a habit of chomping off each other's heads when housed together," which is a problem of raising them in captivity.

17. Paragraph D: i (Experimenting with an old idea - *Thử nghiệm dựa trên ý tưởng cũ từ thế kỷ 19 của Jacob Paul Camboué*)

o Explanation: This paragraph describes how Peers got the idea from a French missionary's work in the 1880s/90s and built a replica machine to experiment with the concept.

18. Paragraph E: iv (Resources needed to meet the project’s demands - *Nguồn lực cần thiết: hơn 1 triệu con nhện và hàng chục công nhân*)

o Explanation: This paragraph details what was needed to "scale up their plan": "fourteen thousand spiders yield about an ounce of silk," "hiring dozens of spidear handlers," finding "people who were willing to work with spiders," and collecting over "1 million female golden orb spiders." These are all resources.

19. Paragraph F: vi (A scientific analysis of spider silk - *Phân tích khoa học về cách nhện chuyển protein lỏng thành sợi rắn*)

o Explanation: This paragraph explains the scientific reason why replicating spider silk is hard: it starts as a "liquid protein," and the spider applies "force to rearrange the protein's molecular structure." This is a scientific analysis of the silk production process.

20. B (Nicholas Godley - *Ông cho biết cần 14.000 con nhện để tạo ra 1 ounce tơ*)

o Location: Paragraph E: "Fourteen thousand spiders yield about an ounce of silk, Godley said..."

21. A (Simon Peers - *Đề cập đến việc nghiên cứu tơ nhện để dùng trong y tế và công nghiệp*)

o **Location:** Paragraph F: "...companies that want to manufacture the fabric for the use as a **biomedical product**..."

22. C (Todd Blackledge - *Ông giải thích rằng mỗi năm chúng ta càng tiến gần hơn đến việc sản xuất hàng loạt*)

o **Location:** Paragraph F: "**Every year we're getting closer and closer** to being able to mass-produce it, but we're not there yet."

23. A (Simon Peers - *So sánh tơ nhện với thép và sợi Kevlar*)

o Location: Paragraph B: "Spider silk is very elastic and strong compared with steel or Kevlar, said textile expert Silom Peers..."

24. bacteria (Các nhà nghiên cứu đưa vật liệu di truyền vào vi khuẩn và động vật)

o Location: Paragraph F: "Several groups have tried inserting spider genes into bacteria or even cows and goats to produce silk..."

25. gland (Tơ nhện bắt nguồn từ protein lỏng được tạo ra trong một tuyến đặc biệt) (P2 - A uni... pp. 3-4)

o Location: Paragraph F: "...it starts out as a liquid protein that's produced by a special gland in the spider's abdomen."

26. force (Khi nhện nhả tơ, nó tác động lực để chuyển chất lỏng thành sợi rắn) (P2 - A uni... pp. 3-4)

o Location: Paragraph F: "...spiders apply force to rearrange the protein's molecular structure and transform it into solid silk."

TRUE IELTS

READING PASSAGE 3

*You should spend about 20 minutes on **Questions 27–40**, which are based on Reading Passage 3 below.*

Sign, Baby, Sign!

A

Language is a powerful tool that humans use for a wide variety of purposes—from expressing emotions and sharing ideas to passing down cultural values and acquiring knowledge. It is not limited to spoken words; gestures, facial expressions, and even posture all contribute to how we communicate. Language, whether signed or spoken, plays a vital role in how we engage with the world around us.

B

In recent years, many American schools have begun to recognize American Sign Language (ASL) as a valid foreign language credit, just like Spanish or French. This change has opened the door for hearing students to choose ASL as an academic subject, which not only gives them a practical skill but also increases their awareness of and empathy toward the Deaf community. Some educators believe this early exposure may even influence students to pursue careers in special education, speech therapy, or interpreting.

C

One clear benefit of learning ASL for hearing children is the opportunity for broader social interaction. Children who understand ASL can communicate with deaf peers, making their social circles more inclusive. Additionally, they may find it easier to express complex ideas or emotions non-verbally, which is helpful in noisy environments or when verbal speech isn't possible.

D

Dr. Marilyn Daniels, a researcher and advocate for baby sign language, has spent over two decades studying the impact of signing on early communication. While she promotes the use of sign language with infants, she emphasizes that there is no need for parents to invent their own signs. Instead, she suggests that parents use ASL or another standardized system to ensure consistency and eventual recognition by others.

E

Very young children often develop motor skills before verbal skills. Dr. Daniels notes that even babies as young as six months can learn to use simple signs like "milk" or "more" with their hands, long before they can articulate those words. This early form of communication can reduce frustration—for both babies and their parents—and may even accelerate speech development.

F

Studies have shown that hearing children exposed to sign language from an early age tend to have stronger reading skills by the time they enter primary school. It is believed that learning sign language can strengthen understanding of symbolic representation and grammar, both of which are foundational to literacy. These cognitive advantages suggest that signing benefits not only communication but academic success as well.

G

There remains some debate about the best approach to language instruction for deaf children. Some educators argue that speech and lip-reading should come first, while others advocate for immediate exposure to sign language. Dr. Daniels believes the latter is more effective and less frustrating for the child. She calls the idea that children must learn to lip-read before learning sign language “an outdated notion.” She, along with other advocates, stresses that deaf children have a right to a full, accessible language from birth—and that language is often sign.

TRUE IELTS

Questions 27–33

Reading Passage 3 has seven paragraphs, A–G.

Which paragraph contains the following information?

Write the correct letter, A–G, in boxes 27–33 on your answer sheet.

NB You may use any letter more than once.

27. **A statement about the different things people use language for**
28. **How knowing ASL may benefit students in their future subject choices**
29. **An assertion that deaf children have a right to be taught a sign language**
30. **An observation regarding the ability of small children to use their hands**
31. **The advantage for hearing children of knowing ASL for wider social interaction**
32. **Different views on when deaf children should be taught to speak**
33. **An observation about the reading ability of primary-school-age hearing children who have been taught ASL**

Questions 34–40

Do the following statements agree with the information given in Reading Passage 3?

In boxes 34–40 on your answer sheet, write:

TRUE — if the statement agrees with the information

FALSE — if the statement contradicts the information

NOT GIVEN — if there is no information on this

34. **Dr. Daniels believes that parents should make up their own gestures to communicate with their babies.**
35. **American Sign Language is the most widely used sign language in the world.**
36. **For hearing children in America, learning American Sign Language is an equivalent option to learning a foreign language.**

37. **Brain research indicates that vocabulary is more easily learned than grammar.**
38. **First and second languages are stored on different sides of the brain.**
39. **Children have less difficulty learning to make signs than learning to make sounds.**
40. **According to Dr. Daniels, the view that deaf children must learn lip-reading before sign language is old-fashioned.**

27. A: Khẳng định về những mục đích khác nhau mà mọi người sử dụng ngôn ngữ (Đoạn A: diễn đạt cảm xúc, chia sẻ ý tưởng, truyền tải giá trị văn hóa...).

28. B: Việc biết ASL có thể mang lại lợi ích cho sinh viên trong các lựa chọn môn học trong tương lai (Đoạn B: ASL được công nhận là tín chỉ ngoại ngữ và ảnh hưởng đến lựa chọn nghề nghiệp sau này).

29. G: Một khẳng định rằng trẻ khiếm thính có quyền được dạy ngôn ngữ ký hiệu (Đoạn G: nhấn mạnh trẻ khiếm thính có quyền tiếp cận ngôn ngữ đầy đủ từ khi mới sinh).

30. E: Một quan sát liên quan đến khả năng sử dụng tay của trẻ nhỏ (Đoạn E: trẻ 6 tháng tuổi có thể học ký hiệu đơn giản trước khi có thể nói).

31. C: Lợi thế cho trẻ có thính giác bình thường khi biết ASL trong tương tác xã hội rộng hơn (Đoạn C: có cơ hội giao tiếp với bạn bè khiếm thính, mở rộng vòng kết nối xã hội).

32. G: Các quan điểm khác nhau về việc khi nào trẻ khiếm thính nên được dạy nói (Đoạn G: tranh luận giữa việc học nói/đọc môi trước hay tiếp xúc với ngôn ngữ ký hiệu ngay lập tức).

33. F: Một quan sát về khả năng đọc của trẻ em ở độ tuổi tiểu học có thính giác bình thường đã được dạy ASL (Đoạn F: những trẻ này có kỹ năng đọc mạnh mẽ hơn khi vào tiểu học).

34. FALSE: Tiến sĩ Daniels tin rằng cha mẹ nên tự tạo ra các cử chỉ của riêng mình để giao tiếp với con. (Sai, đoạn D nói bà khuyên cha mẹ sử dụng ASL hoặc hệ thống chuẩn hóa thay vì tự phát minh).

35. NOT GIVEN: Ngôn ngữ ký hiệu Mỹ là ngôn ngữ ký hiệu được sử dụng rộng rãi nhất trên thế giới. (Thông tin này không được đề cập trong bài).

36. TRUE: Đối với trẻ em ở Mỹ, học ASL là một lựa chọn tương đương với việc học một ngoại ngữ. (Đúng, đoạn B nói ASL được công nhận là tín chỉ ngoại ngữ giống như tiếng Tây Ban Nha hay Pháp).

37. NOT GIVEN: Nghiên cứu về não bộ chỉ ra rằng từ vựng dễ học hơn ngữ pháp. (Bài viết nhắc đến từ vựng và ngữ pháp nhưng không so sánh độ khó khi học).

38. NOT GIVEN: Ngôn ngữ thứ nhất và thứ hai được lưu trữ ở hai bên khác nhau của bộ não. (Thông tin này không có trong bài).

39. TRUE: Trẻ em ít gặp khó khăn khi học các ký hiệu hơn là học tạo ra âm thanh. (Đúng, đoạn E nhấn mạnh kỹ năng vận động phát triển trước kỹ năng ngôn ngữ nói, trẻ dùng ký hiệu sớm hơn nhiều so với khi phát âm).

40. TRUE: Theo Tiến sĩ Daniels, quan điểm cho rằng trẻ khiếm thính phải học đọc môi trước ngôn ngữ ký hiệu là lỗi thời. (Đúng, đoạn G bà gọi đây là "an outdated notion").